

Holiday Deployment Freeze Policy

Engineering Department | Effective: Q4 2024

1. Purpose

This policy establishes guidelines for the annual holiday deployment freeze to ensure system stability during the end-of-year period when engineering support availability is limited. The freeze protects production systems and ensures a positive experience for customers during peak usage periods.

2. Freeze Period

Start Date: December 23, 2024 at 5:00 PM (local time)

End Date: January 2, 2025 at 9:00 AM (local time)

3. Prohibited Activities During Freeze

Activity	Reason
Production deployments	Risk of introducing bugs with limited support
Database migrations	Schema changes can cause service disruption
Infrastructure changes	Network/server changes need monitoring
Feature flag activations	New features may have unexpected behavior
Third-party integrations	External dependencies add risk

4. Emergency Exceptions

Emergency deployments are permitted ONLY for critical security vulnerabilities or production outages affecting more than 10% of users. All emergency deployments require:

- Written approval from Engineering Lead and on-call manager
- Documented rollback plan tested in staging
- Minimum two engineers available for deployment and monitoring
- Post-deployment monitoring for minimum 2 hours

5. On-Call Coverage

Date Range	Primary	Secondary
Dec 23-26	Mike Rodriguez	David Kim
Dec 27-29	David Kim	Mike Rodriguez
Dec 30 - Jan 1	Mike Rodriguez	Sarah Chen

6. Pre-Freeze Checklist

All teams must complete the following before December 23:

- All critical bugs resolved or documented with workarounds
- Monitoring dashboards reviewed and alerts configured
- Runbooks updated for common issues
- On-call engineers briefed on system status
- Customer support team notified of known issues

7. Questions & Contact

For questions about this policy or to request an exception, contact:

Sarah Chen, Product Manager - sarah.chen@company.com

Mike Rodriguez, Engineering Lead - mike.rodriguez@company.com

Last updated: December 1, 2024 | Version 2.1